JOBS WITH BENEFITS

With contractual hiring surging and India's gig economy booming, it's imperative that the ministry pushes for swift implementation of revamped labour codes

By AMARNATH K. MENON



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

MANSUKH MANDAVIYA, 52 | BJP
Minister of Labour & Employment

Humble beginnings Born in Bhavnagar district to a farmer family, he graduated from the local varsity. Earned a doctorate in political science in 2021

Lok Sabha debut A former ABVP leader, Mandaviya became the youngest MLA in Gujarat after winning from Palitana in 2002. Now elected from Porbandar, this is his first stint in the Lok Sabha, after having remained a Rajya Sabha member since 2012

Go-getter After holding multiple portfolios as MoS, he was given charge of the health and family welfare ministry during the peak of Covid-19 pandemic in 2021; took pragmatic measures to tackle oxygen shortage

Minister of State

SOBHA KARANDLAJE , 57 | BJP

The Bangalore North MP is also MoS, MSME

The share of contractual employees in nine major non-farm sectors of the economy more than doubled to nearly 18 per cent in the first half of FY23 from nearly 8.5 per cent in the second half of FY22. These are the findings of the latest Quarterly Employment Survey (QES) released by the Labour Bureau, which covered manufacturing, construction, trade, transport, education, health, accommodation & restaurants, information technology/business process outsourcing and financial services.

At the same time, according to industry estimates, India has over 15 million freelancers working on technology projects, and the country's gig economy is growing at a CAGR of 17 per cent. Amid successive disruptions to the economy, job loss has been a major concern. All these factors make it all the more important for the government to update the nation's cumbersome labour laws.

The ministry already runs schemes that incentivise employers to create new jobs, offer social security benefits and enable restoration of employment during disruptive events like the pandemic. Under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat Rojgar Yojana, for instance, Rs 10,188 crore was reimbursed to over six million beneficiaries till the end of previous fiscal. Electoral evidence would suggest that needs a massive scaling-up. ■